

Shipment SLA and Escalation Policy

Revision 4.2 - Operations Governance Board

Applies to all outbound shipping facilities.

1. Dispatch service levels

A shipment must leave CREATED within a fixed window measured from its created_at timestamp. The window depends on shipment priority:

EXPRESS - 2 hours

STANDARD - 24 hours

ECONOMY - 72 hours

A shipment that exceeds its window is classed as SLA-breaching and must be reported to the duty operations manager on the same shift.

2. Escalation tiers

Tier 1. Facility coordinator. Owns any shipment blocked for less than one SLA window. Resolves trailer assignment and dock issues directly without further approval.

Tier 2. Regional operations manager. Owns any shipment blocked for one to three SLA windows, and any shipment blocked by a facility configuration problem such as outbound dispatch being disabled.

Tier 3. Platform engineering on-call. Owns any shipment blocked by a workflow service error rather than a data problem, and any incident affecting more than ten shipments at one facility.

3. Approval requirements

Any corrective action that writes to production shipment state requires a named human approver before it is applied. This covers assigning a trailer, changing a shipment status, clearing a compliance hold and re-enabling outbound dispatch at a facility.

Read-only investigation never requires approval. Automated systems may diagnose and recommend, but may not apply, a state change.

4. Priority handling for blocked shipments

EXPRESS shipments blocked for any reason are escalated to Tier 2 immediately, bypassing the Tier 1 window. A blocked EXPRESS shipment at an inbound-only facility is a Tier 3 incident because

it indicates an upstream routing defect.

5. Reporting

Every SLA breach is recorded with the shipment identifier, the root cause category, the escalation tier reached and the total blocked duration. Root cause categories are: MISSING_TRAILER, TRAILER_UNAVAILABLE, FACILITY_DISABLED, COMPLIANCE_HOLD and SERVICE_ERROR.